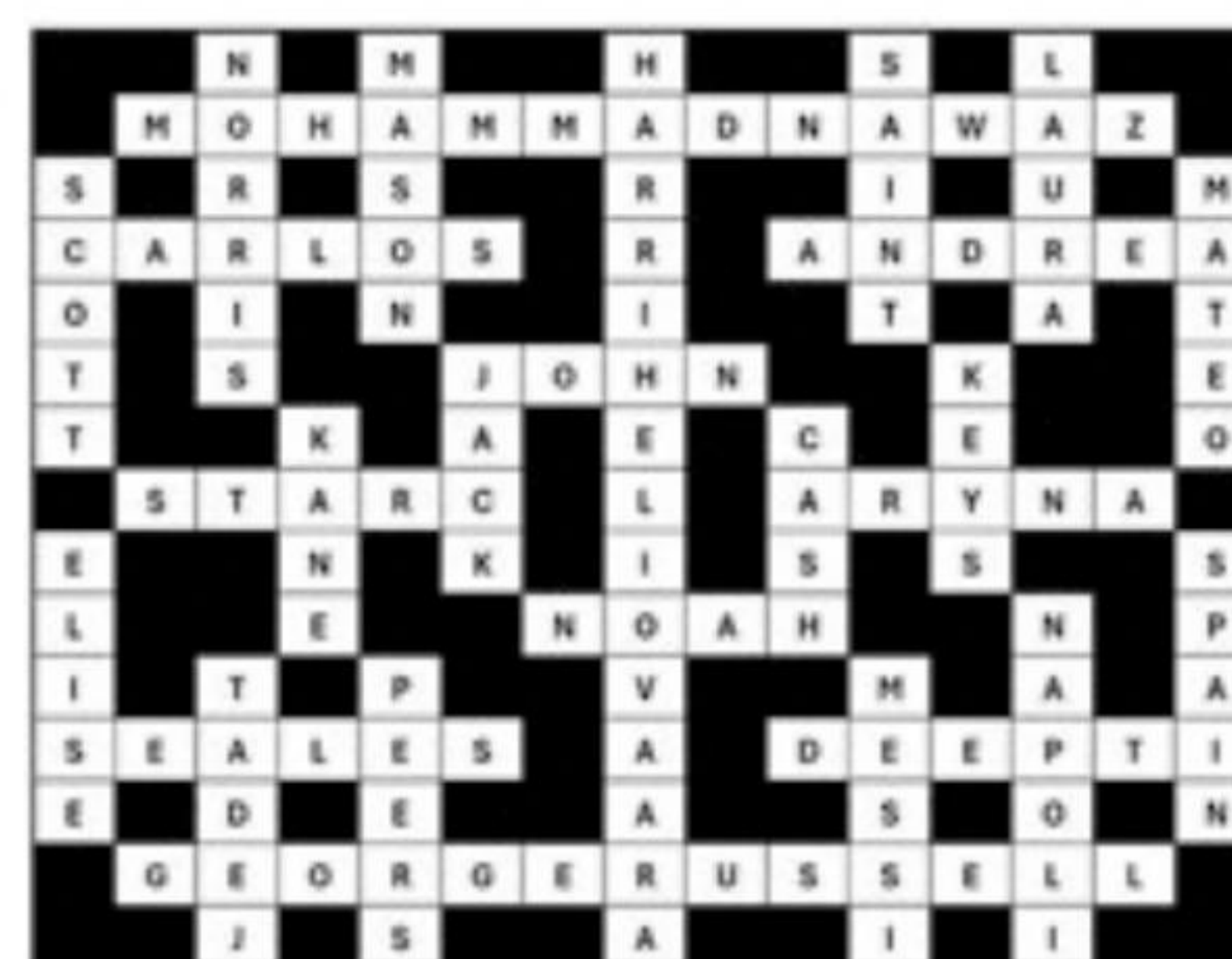
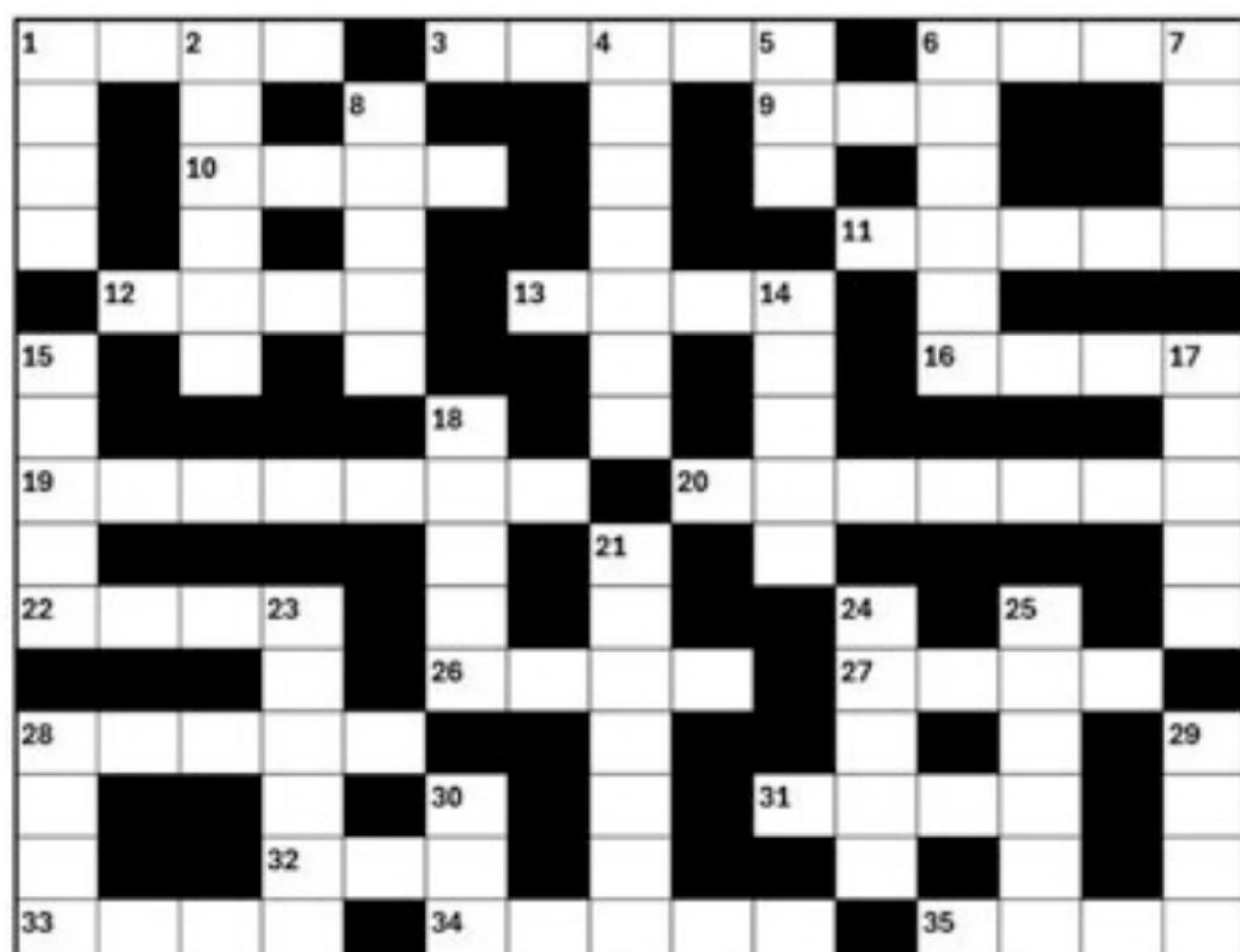


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS

- 1 & 20** Who won the Player of the Series award in the 2025 Asia Cup Rising Stars held in Doha in November 2025? (4,7)
- 3** Identify the first name of this player who scored the only fifty in the first Test held in Kolkata between India and South Africa. (5)
- 6** Identify the first name of this Australian F1 driver who started the 2025 season as the second seat driver for Team Alpine and demoted to a reserve driver after six races. (4)
- 9** Which Australian brothers are part of the famous rock band Six & Out? (3)
- 10** What is the small locality to the north of Bengaluru which also conducts premier Indian domestic Ranji Trophy matches apart from the Chinnaswamy Stadium? (4)
- 11** Identify the first name of this tennis player who won the WTA Tour Finals. (5)
- 12** Identify the surname of this player who won the Player of the Series award in the three-match ODI series held between Pakistan and Sri Lanka in November 2025. (4)
- 13** Identify the surname of the footballer who ended the Premier League 2024-25 as the second top goal-scorer. (4)
- 16** Identify the surname of this bowler who is the first in either men's T20 World Cup or men's ODI World Cup history to take four wickets in a World Cup innings, coming in as the eighth bowling option. (4)
- 19** Identify the surname of this South African spinner who took his maiden five-wicket haul in ODI cricket in August 2025 versus Australia. (7)

- 22** Identify the first name of this tennis player who won the Battle of Sexes match in December 2025. (4)
- 26** Identify the surname of this legendary English umpire who passed away in September 2025. (4)
- 27** Identify the surname of this Australian cricketer who has scored more than 500 runs in the recent Ashes series. (4)
- 28** Identify the surname of this Indian cricketer who won the Player of the Series award in the recently held ODI series against South Africa. (5)
- 31** Identify the first name of this American tennis player who won the French Open women's singles. (4)
- 32** What is the term called when a tennis player's serve cannot be retrieved by the opponent? (3)
- 33** Identify the first name of this French club in Ligue 1 for which former Portugal player and manager Paulo Fonseca is the manager. (4)
- 34 & Down 17** Who held on to most catches in a match in the Women's World Cup held in India recently? (5,5)
- 35** Which club got promoted to Italy's top league Serie A after 34 years for the ongoing 2025-26 season? (4)

DOWN

- 1 & 21** Who won the World Moto GP title in 2025? (4,7)
- 2** Identify the first name of the player who won the women's singles title at the SRFI Indian Open squash in November 2025. (6)
- 4** Identify the surname of the Chelsea FC manager who was axed recently. (7)
- 6** Who was India's flag-bearer in the Deaflympics held in Tokyo in

November 2025? (6)

- 7** Which Brazilian star is one of the 10 players to win the FIFA World Cup, UEFA Champions League and the Ballon d'Or? (4)
- 14** Identify the first name of this West Indies cricketer who, coming in at No. 8, batted for nearly three hours on the fifth day of the first Test versus New Zealand to salvage a draw. (5)
- 15 & 5** Who became the first Pakistani spinner to take a Test hat-trick in January 2025? (5,3)
- 18 & 8** Who won the Player of the Series award in the recently held Test series between New Zealand and West Indies? (5,5)
- 23** Identify the first name of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for Real Madrid in the Champions League match versus Kairat in August 2025. (6)
- 24** Identify the first name of this South African who became the first cricketer to take a wicket off the first ball of her career in WT20I history. (5)
- 25** Which club won the Italian Super Cup in football? (6)
- 28** Identify the second name of this former Indian men's cricketer who played briefly for Northamptonshire in May 2024 before retiring in December 2024. (4)
- 29** Identify the first name of this Indian woman cricketer who retired in July 2025. (4)
- 30** Identify the first name of this former English cricketer who is the only wicketkeeper-batter to score a hundred First-Class hundreds. (3)